



Turtle-headed seasnake

Emydocephalus annulatus

This fully aquatic snake's high-snouted, blunt-nosed head and sharp-edged jaw scales are adapted to scrape up its specialized food: fish eggs, laid in seabed nests. Unlike almost all other seasnakes, it has no need to disable prey, so its venom glands are reduced and its fangs are less than $\frac{1}{25}$ in (1 mm) long. Each individual lives in a small area, where it seems to memorize which eggs are laid where and in which season.

↔ 24–47 in (61–119 cm)

⚖ Up to 3 lb (1.4 kg)

⊗ Common

🐟 Fish eggs

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📍 Philippines, Timor Sea, Coral Sea

▽ LONG LUNG

A single lung that runs almost the length of their body lets seasnakes stay submerged for up to two hours.



Ocean sunfish

Mola mola

After a deep feeding dive, the world's heaviest bony fish basks at the surface to warm up with its disklike body lying side-on. The sunfish's fused jaw teeth form a "beak," which it uses to seize its main prey, jellyfish, and to break up its food. The female releases more eggs than almost any other animal—up to 300 million.



△ SCULLING ACTION

The sunfish's tail is reduced to just a fleshy frill. It swims by moving its elongated dorsal and anal fins from side to side.

↔ Up to 13 ft (4 m)

⚖ Up to 2.2 tons (2 metric tons)

⊗ Not known

🐟 Jellyfish

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📍 Philippines, Timor Sea, Coral Sea

△ REEF COURTSHIP

Male and female green sea turtles are similar-sized, although males have longer tails. Rival males bite and flipper-slap, then the winner shadows the female before grasping her shell with his flipper claws to mate.



<△ RACE FOR LIFE

Hatchlings flailing to the sea are feasted on by crabs, lizards, snakes, gulls, and other predators. In the sea lie more perils including sharks, kingfish, and dolphins.